

Question 1 - Instagram

Three Interaction Styles in Instagram

1. Direct Manipulation:

Double tapping directly on a Photo or Video in the Feed makes it liked instantly, shown by a heart animation appearing right on top of that content. The user acts on the object itself rather than choosing a labelled command.

2. Gesture based interaction:

Swiping sideways moves between a Friend's Stories, and swiping upwards while watching the reel jumps to next video. These are continuous hand movements rather than taps on fixed buttons.

3. Command based interactions:

Typing a username, hashtag, or keyword into the search bar issues a specific "command" that retrieves matching results.

Evaluation: Posting a reel:

The selected task is recording, editing, and ~~Reel~~ uploading a reel from within the app

Execution: Starting the task is very easy a large + icon on the home screen and camera icon. Once you're in the editor you have to go through several screens (trimming, adding music, syncing audio, captions) and a lot of the icons aren't labelled, so it assumes you've already used a video editing app before

Evaluation: When it works, feedback is clear - a progress bar while uploading then the reel appears on your profile grid. But if the upload fails, the app just leaves it sitting there with a retry icon

Research Paper

Reference: Huda, M. Q., & Maulana, R. M. (2023), Usability Evaluation of the Instagram Application Using the Usability Testing Method. Jurnal Perangkai Lunak, 5(3), 259-270.

What the Paper Found: Using the System Usability Scale (SUS) with 50 respondents, Instagram scored 77.6 which falls in the "Good" range but room to improve

How this connects to HCI: It backs up what Reel task shows. an app can look polished and still have small feedback gaps like unreal Failure message